

The Boston Globe

Serving our community since 1872

FRIDAY, JANUARY 10, 2025



ERIC THAYER/ASSOCIATED PRESS

The Eaton fire, which has taken a toll in Altadena and other communities, has burned 4,000 to 5,000 structures.

Progress on fires, but not enough

Even as winds ease, biggest blazes are still running wild

By Corina Knoll,
Soumya Karlamangla,
and Michael Levenson
NEW YORK TIMES

LOS ANGELES — Firefighters, aided by calmer winds and planes and helicopters dropping water, were racing Thursday to try to gain control of roaring wildfires that have upended life in Los Angeles, incinerated neighborhoods, driven thousands from their homes, and

killed at least five people.

Los Angeles Mayor Karen Bass said that the Sunset fire, which started Wednesday evening and raced across the Hollywood Hills, was now 100 percent contained. Hundreds of firefighters worked overnight to control the fire, which had reached 43 acres and had prompted fears that it could spread to the center of the Los Angeles metropolitan area.

But officials warned that the fires remained potentially deadly and unpredictable, and that the two largest and most destructive ones, the Palisades and Eaton fires, were completely uncontained.

With dangerous wind gusts expected to return and no rain in the forecast, officials said that the fires could spread even farther, and that other fires could start.

The Associated Press reported that the fast-growing Kenneth Fire was in the San Fernando Valley near the West Hills neighborhood and close to Ventura County. An evacuation order covered parts of Ventura and Los Angeles counties.

The scale of the destruction, across diverse communities of every socioeconomic status, is already without precedent. The fires have put 360,000 people under mandatory evacuation

FIRES, Page A6

Shelters adding criminal checks

Residents hadn't been screened

By Deirdre Fernandes
and Stephanie Ebbert
GLOBE STAFF

Governor Maura Healey's administration acknowledged for the first time on Thursday that it has not been conducting full criminal background checks on the people staying in the state's homeless shelters, despite repeated assurances for months that the state's vetting process was thorough.

Last March, after a shelter resident was arrested for the alleged rape of a 15-year-old at a Rockland shelter, Healey sought to reassure the public that people who were entering the shelter system were being fully screened.

"This person was vetted by the state in terms of a background check and a check that we do for all entries to our shelter and he cleared that," Healey told reporters.

But on Thursday, amid controversy over the arrest of an undocumented immigrant on drug and weapons charges at a Revere shelter, a

CHECKS, Page A8

Task force looks to millionaire tax to aid T

By Shannon Larson
GLOBE STAFF

A transportation funding task force will recommend the state throw the struggling MBTA a lifeline by using hundreds of millions of dollars from the new tax on millionaires to close its yawning operating deficit and stave off severe cuts in service.

The sudden injection of so sizable a sum would be a profound change for the T — at least in the short run. The agency's day-to-day finances are in dire shape, as ridership and fare revenue have still not recovered since the pandemic, while the costs to run the system have only increased.

Appointed last year by Governor Maura Healey, the 31-member task force will recommend the state use a greater portion of the new 4 percent tax on annual earnings over \$1 million to fund more transportation needs than originally planned, according to interviews with several members of the advisory group. That shift alone could almost instantly solve the T's immediate budget problem.

"The administration envi-

MBTA, Page A8

Goodbye to a president, and more

By Peter Baker
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — The nation bade farewell to former President Jimmy Carter on Thursday with a majestic state funeral for a man who saw himself as anything but, remembering a peanut farmer from Georgia who rose to the heights of power and used it to fight for justice, eradicate disease, and wage peace not war.

Five living presidents and a broad array of other leaders gathered at Washington National Cathedral to pay tribute to the 39th president, not only for his accomplishments during four years in the nation's highest office but also for his relentless humanitari-

At his funeral, Carter is remembered as much for his humanitarian work as for his accomplishments in office

an work in the four decades after he left the White House.

"Throughout his life, he showed us what it means to be a practitioner of good works, a good and faithful servant of God and of the people," President Biden said in a eulogy, delivered just 11 days before he too leaves office as a one-term Democrat. "Today, many think he was from a bygone era. But in reality, he saw well into the future."

The grand service in the ornate cathedral on a hill was a classic Washington spectacle with all the rituals of a presidential passing and all the intrigues of a political convention. As organs played and

CARTER, Page A7



CHIP SOMODEVILLA/GETTY IMAGES

The five living presidents — Bill Clinton, George W. Bush, Barack Obama, Donald Trump, and Joe Biden — were on hand Thursday.

Building a personal connection that would last

By Kevin Cullen
GLOBE STAFF

WINDSOR, Vt. — They met in Mexico in 1990.

Paul Biebel was a Vermont farm boy who became a house builder. Jimmy Carter was a peanut farmer from Georgia who became president.

Toward the end of an insufferably hot day outside Tijuana, Carter sat on an upturned plastic drywall bucket on the porch of an unfinished house, inviting Biebel to sit on an identical bucket next to him.

They were both there working on an ambitious project for Habitat for Humanity, an organization Carter devoted much of his post-presidential energy to, building 100 houses in four days. It was the third day and the only houses finished were the four Paul

Mourning in Boston

At the Edward M. Kennedy Institute, a learning experience. **B1.**



Paul Biebel said yes to Jimmy Carter's appeal and the two worked together on Habitat for Humanity projects around the world.

Biebel built. Carter wanted to meet the man who seemed so adept and efficient at building.

"I just thought he wanted to say hello," Biebel recalled. "We talked for two hours."

Carter wanted to know everything about him, his life story, Biebel said. When Biebel mentioned that his father was a Baptist minister, Carter smiled.

"Oh, that's good," the famously Southern Baptist former president said. "That will work."

Biebel's father, Warren, was a man of deep faith, a trait he passed along to his son, the younger Biebel told Carter that day, and for many years was the chaplain at the Vermont State Prison in Windsor. Long after the prison closed in 1975, Biebel would mar-

BUILDER, Page A7



Globe baseball writers and columnists are revealing their votes for the Baseball Hall of Fame, and as expected, they don't agree on some players.

How does Dustin Pedroia do in his first appearance on the ballot? **C2-3.**

Some classrooms in Boston Public Schools have been frigid this week during the cold snap, forcing students to wear coats and use blankets. **B1.**

In her inaugural address, New Hampshire Governor Kelly Ayotte took aim at a familiar target: Massachusetts. **B1.**

Who will Bostonians point the finger at for a double-digit hike in property taxes? Columnist Shirley Leung's take, **B5.**

Supreme Court clears way for Trump to be sentenced

The president-elect had been trying to delay his sentencing in his hush money case in New York. The 5-4 order — with Chief Justice John Roberts and Justice Amy Coney Barrett joining with the court's three liberals — allows Judge Juan M. Merchan to impose a sentence Friday. He has indicated he won't give Trump jail time, fines, or probation. **A2.**

I thawed so

Friday: Sunny, wind eases. High 36-41. Low 24-29.

Weather and Comics, G6-7. Obituaries, C11.

VOL. 307, NO. 10

*

Suggested retail price \$4.00

